

1.05 Conference & Events At Carlisle Racecourse Novices' Hurdle (Go North Night Nurse Series Qual') (GBB)
£10,000 Total Race Value RTV
2m1f

For 4yo+ which have not won more than two hurdles **Weights** 4yo 10st 2lb; 5yo+ 11st **Penalties** a winner of a hurdle 7lb; of 2 hurdles 12lb **Penalty value** 1st £5,446 2nd £2,509 3rd £1,254 4th £628

SOFT

	Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
 Johnny's Jury 6 11-7	J Snowden	Jonathan Burke	1-2	122	109	131
Promising third over hurdles at Ffos Las (2m4f, soft) last January on sole run for Nicky Henderson and won comfortably on last month's yard debut at Exeter (2m, good to soft), forms that reads very well; leading claims.						
 Kilnesare Flight 6 11-7	D McCain	Brian Hughes	3-1	-	106	125
Runner-up in a point and a bumper (both on soft ground) before winning on hurdle debut at Ayr (2m, heavy) last month; he had some solid yardsticks in behind and is open to further improvement; respected.						
 Knomorediamonds 6 11-7	L Russell & M Scudamore	Alan Doyle (3)	5-1	117	88	130
In good form in handicaps this season, winning easily at Hexham (2m4f, good to soft) in October and running well in defeat at Haydock (2m3f/2m5f, good to soft) on his last two starts; also effective on soft; has been shaping as though this drop back in trip could suit; major player.						
 Coco Masterpiece 9 11-0h	S Crawford (IRE)	J J Slevin	25-1	-	54	87
Very lightly raced 9yo who has won a point and a bumper; one to watch in the betting but he's been pulled up/tailed off this year on his first two hurdle starts, following a long absence.						
 Matching Energy 5 11-0	D Bourke	Callum Bewley	16-1	-	-	116
Won point-to-point bumper last April (2m, good) and made it 2-2 in bumper at Hexham (2m, good to soft) in June; he was the only one to give the heavily odds-on favourite any sort of a race when falling at the final flight over C&D (soft) on hurdle debut; could be involved.						
 McElhattan 5 11-0	D McCain	Theo Gillard	33-1	-	-	-
Won Irish maiden point (3m, soft to heavy) in November on second start; should be capable of better than he showed on bumper debut at Ayr (2m, heavy) last month but was well beaten and needs a big step forward today.						
 The Foreman 8 11-0	J Parkinson & S Smith	Danny McMenamin	100-1	-	-	-
Half-brother to winners Copper Fox (2m hurdle; RPR 106) and Golden Chancer (3m/3m3f hurdle; 103); tailed off at 16-1 on debut in Haydock bumper (1m7f, good to soft) in 2022 and absent since; a watching brief is advised.						
 Khaleesi Queen 6 10-7h	M D Hammond	Joshua Thompson (5)	200-1	-	-	-
Useful pedigree but tailed off at big odds in both bumpers; a transformation is necessary on hurdle debut.						
 Nevershedatear 5 10-7t	O Greenall & J Guerriero	Craig Nichol	66-1	-	52	75
Won on debut in Irish mares' maiden point (3m, yielding) last March but tailed off on first two hurdle starts (2m3f/2m1f, soft/good to soft); needs to be an entirely different proposition now in a tongue-tie.						
 Blondina 4 10-2	A Nicol	Charlie Maggs (5)	50-1	-	80	94
0-6 on the Flat and didn't achieve much; well beaten at 33-1 on hurdle/stable debut at Musselburgh (1m7f, good to soft) and others are preferred.						

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT Having impressed at Exeter last month, **JOHNNY'S JURY** is taken to make it 2-2 for Jamie Snowden. Ayr winner **Kilnesare Flight** is open to further improvement and could be the main danger, although the consistent handicapper **Knomorediamonds** may also be a big threat. Bumper winner **Matching Energy** might go well, too. [Ben Hutton]

1.35 Racing TV Handicap Chase (GBB Race)**£15,000 Total Race Value RTV****2m**

For 5yo + Rated 0-130 (also open to such horses rated 131 and 132 - see Standard Conditions) **Weights raised 1lb** **Minimum weight**
 10-2 **Penalties** after February 7th, each chase won 7lb **Penalty value 1st** £7,921.50 **2nd** £3,645 **3rd** £1,822.50 **4th** £912 **5th** £454.50

GD-SFT

		Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
	Grain D'Oudairies 10 12-0t	D McCain	Brian Hughes	100-30	129	113	130
Two wins towards the end of last year (2m1f/2m4f, good to soft) and 8l second to progressive winner at Doncaster (2m, soft) last time; he can give another good account and is one to consider.							
	Here Comes Georgie 8 11-13t	D Cunha	Lee Edwards	7-1	128	120	134
Unproven on soft ground and tailed off at Ascot last time, although that was in a hot Class 2; went close in Class 3 at Doncaster (2m3f, good to soft) two starts ago and not ruled out now back down in grade.							
	Twoshotsoftequila 9 11-12h	R Menzies	Nathan Moscrop	25-1	127	-	-
Won two in a row in early 2024 but he was having his first run since when pulled up at 25-1 at Haydock on Saturday; best watched.							
	Hardy Du Seuil 9 11-11p	J Snowden	Isabelle Ryder (5)	7-2	126	105	131
Won over hurdles at Windsor (2m, good to soft) in November and respectable fourth at Haydock (2m, good to soft) last month on first chase start since March 2024; has run well on both visits here; might not be far away.							
	Soft Risk 10 11-11	N Richards	Sean Quinlan	6-1	126	-	133
Absent since winning three-runner handicap on chase debut at Ayr (2m, soft) in December 2023; however, that came after a 628-day layoff and no surprise if he runs another big race back from 789 days off this time.							
	Karafon 6 11-10t	S Crawford (IRE)	J J Slevin	6-1	125	85	132
Underwhelming at Down Royal last time when cheekpieces were applied (now left off); however, prior to that he ran well in second at Ayr (2m4f, soft) on his second chase start and has a part to play if rediscovering that form.							
	Hello Judge 10 11-3t	Mrs A Hamilton	Danny McMenamin	7-1	118	128	134
Won here (2m4f, good) in October and followed up at Hexham (2m4f, good to soft); below par at Newcastle and Wetherby since and arrives with something to prove, but he's back on his last winning mark and ten visits to Carlisle have yielded five wins (various ground); not ruled out now back here.							
	Netywell 9 11-0	L Russell & M Scudamore	Patrick Wadge	7-1	115	128	138
9yo who has a regressive profile and his losing sequence is up to 11, but he took a step back in the right direction when fourth at Ayr (2m, soft) last month and continues to drop down the weights; each-way claims.							
	Willie Shake Hands 7 10-8t	S England	Jonathan England	12-1	109	125	134
Won on chase debut at Hexham (1m7f, good) last May and close third of six at Doncaster (2m, good to soft) in December; however, beaten 20l in fifth when upped in grade at Haydock (2m, good to soft) last month and remains in Class 3 company today; a career-best is required.							

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT Nicky Richards has shown with Milcree this winter that a long absence isn't a barrier to success with his stable, and **SOFT RISK** defied a layoff to win at Ayr in December 2023 when last seen. He's attractively handicapped if retaining his old promise. **Grain d'Oudairies** arrives in good heart and is feared most ahead of **Karafon**. [Ben Hutton]

2.05 Come Racing At Carlisle In 2026 Maiden Hurdle (GBB Race)				£10,000 Total Race Value RTV		2m31/2f	
For 4yo+ Weights 4yo 10st 9lb; 5yo+ 11st 9lb		Penalty value 1st £5,446 2nd £2,509 3rd £1,254 4th £628		SOFT			
		Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
	Cool Master 5 11-9	O Greenall & J Guerriero	Toby Wynne	150-1	-	62	73
There's some potential in his pedigree but he was triple-figure odds when tailed off over hurdles on his first two starts.							
	Eagle's Cairn 6 11-9	N Alexander	Bruce Lynn	100-1	-	88	94
Half-brother to 2m7f/3m1f hurdle winner Miss Fairfax (RPR 125); has shown some ability but not enough to suggest he'll make an impact today.							
	Forever Louie 5 11-9	R Menzies	Ross Chapman	8-1	-	-	-
Kept on for 4l second of seven at Musselburgh (1m7f, good to soft) in December and this half-brother to useful 2m4f-2m7f hurdle winner Ryedale Racer is open to improvement now up in trip over hurdles; each-way chance.							
	Good Boy Griff 5 11-9	G Hanmer	Joe Anderson (3)	40-1	-	49	90
Unable to threaten in his three bumpers and same story when 28-1 for recent hurdle debut at Southwell (2m, good to soft); made the frame in a 3m point and the step up in trip may help, but others are still preferred.							
	He's On Fire 5 11-9	W Mullins (IRE)	Mr P W Mullins	2-7	120	-	103
Went close over hurdles at Auteuil (2m2f, heavy) in November on third and final start in France; this looks an excellent opportunity to make a winning start for his top Irish trainer.							
	Johnny Moonshine 5 11-9	D McCain	Theo Gillard	13-2	-	90	113
Point runner-up (3m, good to yielding) who has also shown promise when fourth in a bumper (here; 2m1f, soft) and on hurdle debut at Ayr (2m, soft); the step up in trip looks a good move and he can run well.							
	Passing Diamond 6 11-9	B Haslam	Richie McLernon	50-1	-	42	78
Two Irish point wins; also showed promise in bumpers there; market check advised on stable debut but tailed off at 22-1 at Hereford (2m3f, good to soft) on sole run for Neil Mulholland; has to leave that well behind.							
	Swingingonthesteel 6 11-9	R Menzies	Nathan Moscrop	25-1	106	59	91
Point-to-point bumper winner (2m, soft) who landed two rules bumpers last season (1m7f/2m1f, good to soft); however, he's been unable to transfer that promise to hurdles on his two outings this term.							
	The Dog Thief 6 11-9	T Ellis	Jack Andrews	8-1	-	-	-
5l winner on debut in British maiden point (3m, good to soft) in December; his in-form trainer had a former pointer make a winning hurdle debut at Southwell recently; could give a good account on first rules start.							
	Wherearethethejudges 6 11-9	D Bourke	Callum Bewley	100-1	-	94	98
Has displayed signs of ability but tailed off at Ayr last time and he'll be of greater interest when qualified for handicaps after this.							
	Rosa Diaz 6 11-2t	O Greenall & J Guerriero	Craig Nichol	40-1	-	103	111
Won Irish mares' maiden point (3m, yielding) on debut in November 2024; fairly encouraging hurdle debut when fifth at Ludlow (2m5f, good to soft) in December 2025; a lesser run followed at Sedgefield (2m4f, good to soft) but she's an each-way contender if back on song this afternoon.							

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT Willie Mullins has sent just one runner to Carlisle today and **HE'S ON FIRE** can make a winning start for his new connections having gone close at Auteuil in November when last seen. **Johnny Moonshine** is open to improvement now up in trip on his second hurdle start and could be best of the rest ahead of British point winner **The Dog Thief**. [Ben Hutton]

2.35 Book Your Raceday Hospitality Now Handicap Chase
(Challenger Staying Chase Series Qualifier) (GBB)
£19,000 Total Race Value RTV
3m1/2f
For 5yo+ Rated 0-130 (also open to such horses rated 131 and 132 - see Standard Conditions)
Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after
February 7th, each chase won 7lb Penalty value 1st £10,033.90 2nd £4,617 3rd £2,308.50 4th £1,155.20 5th £575.70
GD-SFT

	Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
	Saint Davy 9 12-2p Having ended last season in the doldrums he returned to form when third of five in first-time cheekpieces (retained) on last month's reappearance at Windsor (3m, soft); he goes well fresh so it remains to be seen if he'll improve for that latest outing, but he's respected nevertheless.	J & A J O'Neill Jonjo O'Neill Jr	3-1	132	120	136
	Westerninthepark 8 11-11 Promising fourth on reappearance here (3m2f, good to soft) in November and now 4lb lower; however, soundly beaten in Becher Chase next time and pulled up at Windsor (2m6f, soft) recently; has to get back on track.	O Murphy Sean Bowen	13-2	127	121	136
	Ayiko 7 11-10t Bumper and maiden hurdle (3m, soft) winner who ran well when 2l second of three finishers in beginners' chase at Haydock (2m4f, soft) in December on first run over fences; could build on that now back up in trip; firmly in calculations.	S Crawford (IRE) J J Slevin	7-2	126	76	133
	Sound And Fury 9 11-8p Took chase record to 3-6 when winning here (3m2f, good to soft) in November on reappearance; has also won on soft; lost a shoe and bled from the nose when sixth of 16 at Cheltenham next time; no obvious excuses when tailed off at Market Rasen last time but shouldn't be written off now back here.	B Pauling Ben Jones	9-1	124	93	132
	Hudson De Grugy 9 11-4v Returned to form with 18-1 win at Wetherby (3m, soft) two starts ago; tailed off at Windsor (3m4f, soft) since but he was still bang there jumping four out and could have a big part to play now back down in trip.	S England Jonathan England	16-1	120	106	134
	President Scottie 8 10-12 Soundly beaten in the Borders National (4m, soft) and over hurdles at Ayr (3m, soft) on his last two starts; however, prior to those he was a respectable fourth on his reappearance over fences at Ayr (3m, soft) and is now 6lb lower; not discounted in view of that dangerous mark.	N Richards Danny McMenamin	7-1	114	125	133
	Upfordebate 7 10-7tp Made it four wins from his last five starts, and took his form to a new level, when winning easily in first-time cheekpieces (retained) at Sedgefield (3m2f, soft) in December last time; 9lb higher in a better race today but he's clearly thriving and may well play another leading role.	P Neville Brian Hughes	11-4	109	117	135

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT 3m handicap hurdle winner **AYIKO** goes back up in trip for his second chase start and earns the vote ahead of **Hudson De Grugy**, who ran well for a long way over 3m4f at Windsor last time. The highly progressive **Upfordebate** is third choice now up in grade. [Ben Hutton]

3.05 Carlisle Conditional Jockeys' Novices' Limited Handicap Hurdle £6,250 Total Race Value 2m31/2f

For 4yo + Rated 0-95 **Weights** highest weight 11st 12lb **Weights raised** 2lb **Minimum weight** 10-5, **3-y-o** 10-2 **Penalties** after February 7th, each hurdle won 7lb **Penalty value** 1st £3,300.62 2nd £1,518.74 3rd £759.38 4th £380 5th £189.38

SOFT

	Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
 Scairp Dubh 6 11-12	J Parkinson & S Smith	Jack Power	7-2	93	80	93
Won point bumper last March; has been feeling his way over hurdles for new yard and while a handicap debut at Catterick was just mildly encouraging, he fared better when a close fourth in a big field at Newcastle (2m4f, good to soft) last month; can do better again; thereabouts.						
 Tech That 7 11-12p ¹	R Phillips	Finn Lambert	14-1	93	48	89
Early promise in different spheres in 2024; lightly raced and has not shown much since, the return to 2m4f, in his second handicap, not obviously helpful at Uttoxeter recently; cheekpieces now fitted; much more needed.						
 Wind Your Neck In 7 11-8t	S England	Oscar Palmer (3)	7-1	89	98	97
Three Flat wins but 0-11 over hurdles and although he's weighted to win a race he didn't shine when upped to 2m4f at Market Rasen (good to soft; favourite) last time out; has plenty to prove with this stiff test.						
 Upthereforthinking 7 11-7v ¹	J Coulson	Philip Armson	50-1	88	94	92
Bits of form at up to 2m4f but he had a serious chunk of time off the track and although his December return, on tough terms in a seller, was inconclusive, it's hard to know what he's capable of now; first-time visor replaces cheekpieces.						
 Knockeranna Rose 6 11-7	S Corbett	Conor Rabbitt	9-1	88	60	88
Little to show for his three runs in novice and maiden hurdles but there was clear evidence of ability in a course bumper (good) in October and an improved showing on his handicap debut is very much on the cards.						
 Perfectot 5 11-3tp ¹	R Menzies	Alan Doyle	20-1	84	63	80
Not disgraced in mares' bumpers but big prices and has finished remote in three hurdle runs; may fare better now handicapping at a realistic level but another headgear switch (cheekpieces replace a hood) raises a doubt.						
 Fine As Wine 8 11-3	G Hanmer	Benjamin Macey (3)	9-1	84	65	93
Had some quite useful Irish point form in this context in 2023, only just failing in a race that worked out well; later had two years off the track; weak in the market and well held in three qualifying hurdle runs but this low-key start to her handicap career makes her worth a look.						
 Parish Star 6 10-13	A Nicol	Joshua Thompson	11-10	80	50	100
Very ordinary handicap form in 2024 but she's come into her own for new yard, getting up near the line at Newcastle and quite impressive at Southwell (both about 2m4f; heavy and good to soft) 14 days ago; hooded each time but not today; back up 8lb but this stiff test can suit; respected.						
 Do Ye Wanna 8 10-13	G Bewley	Edward Austin	50-1	80	16	92
Friendless in the market for all starts in bumpers and over hurdles, pulling up twice in last four attempts; this will be more his level but others have much more obvious claims.						
 Junkyard Dog 4 10-12t	I Jardine	William Maggs	20-1	93	96	100
Won 1m2f handicap at Navan (RPR 75) last spring but he hasn't found his level over hurdles as yet, failing to pick up when 28-1 and finishing remote on handicap debut at Newcastle (2m4f, good to soft; Scairp Dubh fourth) last month; has plenty of work to do.						
 Gold Ring 9 10-5	N Mechie	Charlie Maggs	66-1	72	33	35
Two Flat wins, the latest at 2m in 2023, but he's shown very little in a handful of starts on the Flat and over hurdles since spring 2024.						
 Liloo D'Ores 9 10-5tv ¹	G Hanmer	Joe Anderson	20-1	72	72	98
Maiden who is out of the weights and can hardly appeal on recent efforts but she did at least finish close up over C&D last April and has dropped a long way in the weights since; visor added (often wears cheekpieces).						

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT There's always potential danger among handicap newcomers and **Fine As Wine** and **Knockeranna Rose** would come into it on their past form in other disciplines but this may lie between **Scairp Dubh** and **PARISH STAR**. The former is steadily getting it together at this level and can be a big danger but Parish Star gets the vote despite this race looking likely to take more winning than either of her two handicap wins for this yard.[Emily Weber]

3.35 Sandy Molloy Memorial Handicap Hurdle**£8,750 Total Race Value****2m1f**For 4yo + Rated 0-110 (also open to such horses rated 111 and 112 - see Standard Conditions)
February 7th, each hurdle won 7lb**Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after**
1st £4,620.87 **2nd** £2,126.24 **3rd** £1,063.13 **4th** £532 **5th** £265.13**SOFT**

		Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
	Azahara Palace 6 11-12	A Keatley	Brian Hughes	11-2	110	76	105
Quite useful at up to 1m4f on the Flat for Hughie Morrison; got off the mark over hurdles in a mares' novice at Hexham (2m, heavy) in December but beaten 10l in similar event at Catterick last time (1m7f, good); quite interesting back on a stiff track on handicap debut.							
	He's Bresilian 6 11-12	Jedd O'Keeffe	Sean Quinlan	7-2	110	89	116
Got off the mark when winning a maiden hurdle at Newcastle (2m1f, good to soft) in December and ran another sound race when second in an Ayr handicap (2m, heavy) since; progressive and a contender.							
	Soldier's Leap 6 11-9ht	T Ellis	Jack Andrews	5-1	107	98	113
Has progressed since wind surgery early last year, winning handicaps at Stratford (2m2f, good to soft) and Utttoxeter before decent fifth at Newbury (2m, good to soft) latest; 10lb higher than last winning mark but solid chance.							
	Celestial Reign 5 11-8tp	M D Hammond	Joshua Thompson (5)	25-1	106	96	110
Won a maiden hurdle over 2m4f at Sedgefield in May (good); good second over this C&D (good to soft) next time but mainly disappointing since; others stronger.							
	Rock Hurley 8 11-7t	D McCain	William Maggs (5)	16-1	105	39	116
Easy winner off a 12lb lower mark at Bangor (2m3f, good to soft; form sound) in April; well below that form in both starts since and has a bit to prove at present.							
	Vampire Slayer 6 11-7v	D Bourke	Callum Bewley	100-30	105	100	113
Two from two since visor went on, winning at Catterick (1m7f, soft) and Sedgefield (2m1f, good to soft; won by 13l); put up 9lb for last win but should be competitive again.							
	Russian Virtue 9 11-7p	D Thompson	Theo Gillard	20-1	105	102	112
Has won six times over hurdles, the latest a two-runner affair over C&D (good to soft) in December 2023; a couple of fair runs for this yard last year but pulled up when last seen out in January (reportedly never travelling); others appeal more.							
	Book Of Secrets 8 11-7ht	J Moffatt	Leah Noreci (10)	25-1	105	109	115
Has won only one of his 19 starts over hurdles, a Market Rasen maiden in August 2023 (2m, good to soft); fair second at Newton Abbot in September (2m1f, good to soft) but well beaten over C&D last twice.							
	Swinging London 8 11-5tp	J Mackie	Ben Jones	12-1	103	100	115
Has won four times on the AW but sole jumps win was in a maiden hurdle at Fakenham in February 2022 (2m, soft); has a chance on his Leicester second (1m7f, soft) in November but a bit disappointing since.							
	Fostered Phil 12 11-5t	W Young Jnr	Danny McMenamin	14-1	103	103	111
Veteran who won twice in 2025, the second by 7l over C&D (soft) in December; now 5lb higher in a stronger race.							
	Lady Babs 12 11-4p	Andrew Crook	Conor Rabbitt (3)	33-1	102	94	113
Veteran mare who has won seven races, three of them over C&D, but hasn't been in the best of form this season and others appeal more.							
	Two Auld Pals 8 11-4	L Russell & M Scudamore	Gregor Walkingshaw (10)	10-1	102	94	116
Five-time Flat winner who has a consistent profile over hurdles; handles soft ground but has a bit to find with He's Bresilian on last month's Ayr form.							
	Dee's Getaway 6 11-3t	G Bewley	Edward Austin (5)	20-1	101	101	112
Ex-Irish; 33-1 winner at Ayr (2m, soft; tongue-tie refitted) in November on second run for present yard but she hasn't run as well since, last time when stepped up to 3m; others look stronger.							
	Interchangeable 6 11-2	J Dixon	Mr John Dixon (7)	20-1	100	72	108
Won Navan maiden hurdle for Stuart Crawford in December 2024 (2m3f, good to yielding); hasn't run up to his best in three starts for present yard but is down to a good mark.							

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT The progressive **SOLDIER'S LEAP** is taken to win his third handicap of the season. **He's Bresilian** (second choice) and **Vampire Slayer** are two others who should go well. [Colin Russell]

4.05 Watch Racing TV Now Handicap Chase (Go North Monet's Garden Series Qualifier) (GBB Race)
£9,750 Total Race Value **RTV**
2m4f

For 5yo+ Rated 0-110 (also open to such horses rated 111 and 112 - see Standard Conditions) **Weights raised 4lb Minimum weight**
 10-2 **Penalties** after February 7th, each chase won 7lb **Penalty value 1st** £5,148.97 **2nd** £2,369.24 **3rd** £1,184.63 **4th** £592.80 **5th** £295.43

GD-SFT

	Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
 Trac 9 12-0b	M D Hammond	Brian Hughes	9-2	106	92	106
Returned to form to win in first-time blinkers (retained) at Newcastle (2m4f, good to soft) in December; back up 5lb he remains 2lb lower than when scoring here (2m, heavy) in April 2024 and he's one to consider.						
 Cuzco Du Mathan 8 11-13v	J Moffatt	Leah Noreci (10)	16-1	105	81	110
Two wins at Cartmel (2m1f, soft/heavy) in 2024 and he's below his last winning mark; however, he wasn't at the same level on his four starts in 2025 and this is his first run since last August; others appeal more.						
 Sean Og 8 11-13	Mrs D Sayer	Peter Kavanagh	13-2	105	105	111
Won at Cartmel (2m5f, soft) last June and runner-up at Perth (3m, good) in September; below par at Hexham in October when last seen but a break may have helped and he can go well fresh; could be a contender on his return.						
 Canunclecani 7 11-10	J Stephen	Sean Quinlan	16-1	102	-	-
Tailed off on recent handicap hurdle debut at Ayr (3m, soft) and takes on seasoned chasers on this first runs over fences; however, his most promising runs in novice hurdles came here and this point runner-up could be suited by the switch to chasing; interesting.						
 Baptism Of Fire 11 11-10	J K Hunter	Edward Austin (5)	100-1	102	-	-
Very useful for Henry de Bromhead in his prime but pulled up on all four runs since returning from long layoff for new yard last February.						
 Largy Train 9 11-10p	H Hogarth	Charlie Maggs (5)	7-2	102	104	112
Completed hat-trick when winning here (2m5f, soft) in March 2024; lightly raced since and he got back on the scoresheet at Sedgefield (2m3f, good to soft) three weeks ago; he can give another good account up 4lb.						
 Wolfburg 7 11-5tp	A Thomson	Callum Bewley	3-1	97	101	117
Won in fine style at Wetherby (2m3f, soft) on Boxing Day and ran another big race when third at Catterick (3m1f, soft) last month, when he travelled well but was outstayed; lots to like now back down in distance.						
 Streamsforth Lad 8 11-2tp ¹	G Hanmer	Benjamin Macey (5)	13-2	94	-	-
15-race maiden who was pulled up on chase debut last February and unseated mid-race when back over fences two months ago; he has something to prove in this sphere but perhaps the first-time cheekpieces will help and he's on a handy mark on his November hurdle form; possible contender.						
 Hawkseye View 7 10-12p	J Parkinson & S Smith	Danny McMenamin	13-2	90	98	109
Point winner who made it 0-18 under rules when below par at Market Rasen in Boxing Day, when the tongue-tie was left off and cheekpieces were applied (same today); however, he was in good heart prior to last time and might not be far away if bouncing back to form.						
 Westerdale 7 10-2	M Walford	William Maggs (5)	20-1	80	-	-
Very lightly raced 7yo who is one to watch in the betting on her chase debut; however, she struggled in her three handicap hurdles and is 5lb wrong at the weights this afternoon, so has plenty to prove.						

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT The drop back in trip should be ideal for **WOLFBURG (nap)**, who was a convincing winner over an extended 2m3f at Wetherby on Boxing Day before being outstayed over 3m1f at Catterick. **Canunclecani** is a possible improver now switched to fences and is second choice ahead of the consistent **Largy Train** and fellow last-time winner **Trac**. [Ben Hutton]

4.35 Next Raceday Sunday 8th March Mares' Handicap Hurdle**£6,750 Total Race Value** **RTV****3m1f**For 4yo+ fillies & mares Rated 0-105 Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after February 7th, each hurdle won 7lb Penalty value 1st
£3,564.67 2nd £1,640.24 3rd £820.13 4th £410.40 5th £204.53**SOFT**

	Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
 Keppel Queen 7 12-0	O Murphy	Sean Bowen	4-1	104	88	105
Won a maiden hurdle on stable debut at Warwick (2m5f, good) in October and bounced back from a flop over fences when third of five in handicap hurdle at Plumpton (3m1f, soft) in January, when jumping to the right; the return to a right-handed track is a likely plus and she's high on the list.						
 Hellfire Princess 9 11-13	K Lee	Conor O'Farrell	16-1	103	93	101
9yo who is lightly raced for her age and won at Ffos Las (2m6f, soft) in November on second run back from break; not seen to same effect at Ludlow (2m5f, soft) 12 days ago but she's better than that; not ruled out.						
 Vroomoz Eile 7 11-11	J Moffatt	Leah Noreci (10)	10-1	101	100	108
Won novice hurdle here (2m3f, soft) last February and she returned to form when third of seven at Haydock (3m, good to soft) in December following a break; could build on that latest effort and she's a possible player.						
 Smile Back 6 11-11h	R Phillips	Finn Lambert (3)	7-1	101	100	105
Course bumper winner (soft) who was runner-up at Leicester (2m4f, soft) towards the end of last year in her first two handicaps; only sixth when upped in trip at Taunton (3m, good to soft) last month but she could better that latest run when back on soft ground, on which she's shown her best form.						
 Lizzie Luna 6 11-9	Ewan Whillans	Craig Nichol	5-1	99	78	105
Went very close when upped to 3m at Musselburgh (good to soft) in December; also effective on soft ground; only fourth of eight at Musselburgh (3m, good to soft) since and could do with settling better but not ruled out.						
 Zhanma Enki 5 11-5t	S Crawford (IRE)	J J Slevin	7-1	95	40	87
13l third of five in sole bumper and soundly beaten on all three hurdle starts (2m/2m5f); however, this half-sister to classy stayer Yala Enki could relish this step up in trip on handicap debut, for which she wears a first-time tongue-tie; interesting, especially if strong in the betting.						
 Maura Jeanne 9 11-5tp	I Duncan	Alan Doyle (3)	7-2	95	79	105
Inconsistent, with just two wins from her 30 starts, but they both came last season and she's run well to be second on two of her last three outings (2m7f/3m, good to soft/heavy); could be thereabouts once more.						
 It's Maisy 8 11-3	J Parkinson & S Smith	Danny McMenamin	6-1	93	95	105
Ran okay when fourth of seven at Newcastle (2m4f, heavy) three weeks ago and continues to edge down the weights; she's won at up to 3m1f and might not be far away now back up in trip.						
 Moveonbuy 6 10-7	Andrew Crook	William Maggs (5)	12-1	83	84	104
Inconsistent sort who was soundly beaten at Southwell a fortnight ago; however, she won at Cartmel (2m6f, soft) last June and was beaten just a head at Wetherby (3m, soft) two starts ago; not discounted.						

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT **Keppel Queen** is a tempting option now going back right-handed but this could go to **ZHANMA ENKI**, a half-sister to the classy stayer Yala Enki who may well relish the step up in trip on handicap debut. Last month's Ayr runner-up **Maura Jeanne** is third choice.[Ben Hutton]